

Stats for Sociologists

Course: SOC6302H1F

Instructor: Professor Pepin

Date: October 21, 2025

INSTRUCTIONS:

Fill out the first page of the scantron. Confirm you have included:

- The form code (A or B)
- Your student number (write the number and fill in the ovals)
- Your surname and first initial (write the letters and fill in the ovals)

1. What does Oscar Gandy suggest about the use of racial statistics?
 - (a) Their use in data journalism helps mitigate online polarization
 - (b) They can both expose and perpetuate discrimination
 - (c) They are neutral tools most useful for academic research
 - (d) Their use in legal proceedings increasingly lead to unfair policy outcomes
2. The level of measurement for the `hapmar` variable is _____.
[1] "Happiness of marriage" [1] "very happy" "pretty happy" "not too happy"
 - (a) ordinal
 - (b) nominal
 - (c) dichotomous
 - (d) interval
3. What does the `::` operator do in R?
 - (a) Comments out a line of code
 - (b) Specifies a function from a particular package (without loading it)
 - (c) Assigns a value to a variable
 - (d) Imports all functions from a package
4. In order to compare meaningfully across groups, a frequency should be converted into a/an _____.
 - (a) standard deviation
 - (b) ordinal variable
 - (c) number
 - (d) percentage
5. What will happen if you try to use a function from a package that hasn't been loaded?
 - (a) R will prompt you to install the package
 - (b) You will get an error saying the function is not found
 - (c) R will automatically load the package
 - (d) The function will run normally
6. What is Wheelan's primary message of Chapter 1 ("What's the Point?") in *Naked Statistics: Stripping the Dread from the Data*?
 - (a) Statistics simplify complex information to help us make better decisions
 - (b) Statistics explain why relationships exist between variables
 - (c) Statistics provide honest answers to complex questions
 - (d) Statistical formulas are the most important part of understanding data
7. Which command installs a new package in R?
 - (a) `library()`
 - (b) `install.packages()`
 - (c) `require()`
 - (d) `load()`
8. Which function is used to load a package in R?
 - (a) `load()`
 - (b) `install.packages()`
 - (c) `source()`
 - (d) `library()`
9. Which RStudio pane is used to write and edit R scripts and Quarto documents?
 - (a) Files
 - (b) Source
 - (c) Console
 - (d) Environment

1. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
2. (a) ☒ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
3. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
4. (a) ☐ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☒
5. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
6. (a) ☒ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
7. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
8. (a) ☐ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☒
9. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐